Agri-Food Commodity Prices

Prepared by Anushree Prasad | Tools: Python, Power BI | 11 November 2026

Rubber, rice and wheat recorded strong year-on-year gains, while coconut oil and Kolkata tea were lower than a year earlier.

Market snapshot

Five of the eight benchmarks were at least 14% higher than in October 2025. Palm oil rose more modestly, while tea and coconut oil declined. Prices are monthly averages in nominal US dollars.

Commodity	Oct 2026 price	Change vs Oct 2025
Rubber (RSS3)	$2.83/kg	+42%
Rice (Thai5%)	$489/mt	+37%
Wheat (USHRW)	$317/mt	+37%
Sugar (world)	$0.43/kg	+26%
Maize	$226.5/mt	+14%
Palm oil	$1,120/mt	+8%
Tea (Kolkata)	$2.55/kg	–11%
Coconut oil	$2,029/mt	–20%

Volatility and seasonality

Kolkata tea was the most volatile benchmark over the ten-year period, with a standard deviation of 17.9% in monthly price changes. Coconut oil followed at 8.0%, while rice was the steadiest at 5.3%. Tea's result was influenced by an 87% jump in June 2020; the cause was not verified in this analysis. By comparison, the average across three tea auction centres was much steadier, at about 5.2%, so the Kolkata series should be interpreted carefully.

Kolkata tea also has a pronounced yearly cycle. From 2016 to 2025, prices averaged around 32% below their annual average in March and 23% above it in July. Most other commodities showed much weaker seasonality, generally within about 7% of their yearly average.

Outlook

Rice is projected at about $489/mt in April 2027, with a likely range of $399–$592/mt (roughly -18% to +21%). The range reflects substantial uncertainty. A backtest covering October 2021 to April 2026 compared three simple six-month forecasting methods. For most commodities, assuming prices would remain at their current level was difficult to beat. Kolkata tea was the exception: a seasonal method had an average error of about 12%, compared with 33% for the unchanged-price approach. The forecast range uses the 10th and 90th percentiles of the methods past errors.

Data note and source

These are global benchmark prices in nominal US dollars, not Indian mandi prices. Forecast ranges are indicative ,not guarantees. Source: World Bank Commodity Price Data (The Pink Sheet), monthly data through October 2026; accessed 10 November 2026.

Methodology

Cleaned and processed 10+ years of World Bank Pink Sheet monthly data in Python (Pandas, NumPy) to calculate YoY changes, rolling standard deviations, seasonal indices, and 6-month forecast backtests; visualized trends in Power BI and used AI tools to cross-verify benchmark definitions.